GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

ISSUE 5

# GALLIONS grapevine

July 2001

# Gallions Reach Urban Village

## *The keys to the first new Gallions homes are handed to Tony Cotter*



Pictured Tony Cotter, Chief Executive with Keith Holt, Site Manager from Barratts. In the background are representatives from Barratts, Gallions and AJP Frankhams.

**The first new homes built by Gallions Housing Association have been completed and are in the process of being handed over to new tenants.**

This exciting new development includes 30 new homes built for Gallions Housing Association for rent. They consist of 2 and 3 bedroom houses, 6 of which are fully accessible for people in wheelchairs.

The new houses are located within the second phase of Gallions Reach Urban Village alongside Western Way in Thamesmead, where nearly 280 new homes are being built by private developers for outright sale.

Several of the new houses to be let are close to a new canal which will provide a rich habitat for wildlife and runs through the development. This connects with the network of lakes and waterways that characterise the green spaces and parks of Thamesmead.

The houses have all been built to Housing Corporation standards and are of a high quality.

The Chairman of Gallions, John Fahy said "I am very proud and pleased that these first homes to be built by our Association are offering such wonderful accommodation to the people of Thamesmead and Greenwich. We have set a very high standard which we intend to maintain on all our future developments".

Tenants who are registered with Gallions Housing Association and London Borough of Greenwich are now moving into these new properties, which will be managed by Gallions Housing Association.

The project cost the Association just over £2.5 million. The scheme was designed and built to the Association's specification by major developer Barratts.

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## *Gallions Reach Urban Village*
*continued*

The Association intends that this should be part of a new and ambitious major building programme that will take place over the next few years.

### Phase 5

One of the next phases to get underway is Phase 5, which is located next to Phase 2 at Western Way, Thamesmead. Work on-site is due to start in Autumn 2001. The houses will take 12 months to complete.

There will be a further 32 homes built for Gallions Housing Association and made available for rent. Four of these homes will be built for full wheelchair accessibility.

The 32 homes will consist of 2 and 3 bedroom houses, and also 3 bedroom town houses.

# Working together towards a safer environment

**The high level of vandalism in Thamesmead is a constant reminder to us all as to the huge task we face in trying to create a safer environment. It is only a minority of people who vandalise the area, but it affects us all. We need to do something about it and that means taking responsibility.**

I am constantly reminded that there are not enough facilities for young people. Those facilities we have need to be improved but there is no excuse for the constant attacks on the Town Centre, Shopping Parades and Bus Stops or the number of fires on our Estates.

Travelling through Thamesmead on a Monday morning is a painful reminder of the issues we face. All of us who have contact with young people, including parents and carers, have a responsibility for the actions of those young people.

The Thamesmead Community Safety Partnership, developed by Gallions with the support of the Metropolitan Police and others, will be launching new initiatives to stem the tide in the coming months. Local Authorities and the Police have a range of measures that can be brought to bear under the Crime & Disorder Act. These include curfews and Anti-Social Behaviour Orders. Gallions of course can exercise its powers under the Tenancy Agreement, where it can be proven that either tenants or their relations have been involved in acts of vandalism.

Let us all join together to support one another in the fight against crime and disorder. Report acts of vandalism, use the Crimestoppers Number below. It is a freephone number and can make an enormous difference.

The Police also have a role to play. All Thamesmead residents were asked to pay a significant increase in the Metropolitan Police Precept, which was determined by the Mayor of London, Ken Livingstone. We are entitled and deserve to see more police on the streets of Thamesmead and we will activiely campaign to achieve that objective.

Write to me, John Fahy, Chair at Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH if you wish to put forward your ideas for making Thamesmead a safer place.

**Crimestoppers No.** **0800 555111**



**John Austin MP and John Fahy outside the new Urban Village disabled units.**



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# First Board Elections


Liz Gardiner


Ken Sealey


Wendy Bradbury


Terry Graves


Graham Horton


Sam Robinson

Photographs courtesy of Abbey

**The first election for Tenant and Charge-payer representation to the Board of Gallions Housing Association has now taken place. All nominations were from The Estate Management Board membership.**

This is to ensure that the Tenants and Charge-payers going onto the Board of Gallions Housing Association have a strong representation and reflect the needs of Thamesmead as a community.

The aim of these members will be to:

- **Support the work of the Board of Gallions Housing Association**
- **Influence policy and improve services**
- **Connect with the community**
- **Bring amenities for leisure activities**

Gallions Housing Association would like to take this opportunity to welcome its new Board members.

Congratulations go to the tenant representatives, Liz Gardiner, Terry Graves, Wendy Bradbury, Sam Robinson, Graham Horton and to the Charge-payer representative, Kenneth Sealey.

Tony Cotter, Chief Executive, said *"I am delighted that the first Board elections have been such a success. Any successful organisation needs to listen to its customers and there is no better way than having customers on the Board"*.



## *Welcome to our new Finance Director*

Gallions Housing Association would like to welcome Fred Angole as our new Finance Director. Fred joined the Housing Association on the 27th June.

# Consultation and Regeneration of Tavy Bridge



*feel good about it...*

**On-site consultations took place between the 6th and 11th July at Tavy Bridge. The aim of the consultation is to gain the views of the residents, businesses and workers in the Tavy Bridge area.**

Gallions Housing Association together with Trust Thamesmead found four young local people to carry out consultations regarding the Tavy Bridge Project.

Regeneration ideas are described in a leaflet which explains some of the suggested improvements. A questionnaire accompanies the leaflet. All completed questionnaires will be entered into a prize draw and winners picked at random. **There is over £700 worth of Sainsbury vouchers to be won!**

If you live in the Tavy Bridge area but didn't manage to see our researchers, you will shortly receive the leaflet and questionnaire in the post. There will also be a Residents Association formed so that your views can be heard. Look out for the posters in your area.

Gallions Housing Association wants to hear your views, so please use this opportunity to make yourself heard.















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# Thamesmead Ecopark

**Thamesmead is to be home to an exciting new ground-breaking project. Situated near to the Urban Village, the project is a development of 39 new homes, made up of 6 three bed mobility units, 24 three bed homes and 8 four bed homes.**

The properties, which are extremely eco-friendly and sustainable, are due to be ready in August 2002. Gallions Housing Association, together with Willmott Dixon and PRP Architects, have developed this scheme, which is strongly influenced by Dutch methods of building and architecture.



**Unusual features include:**

- **solar panels on the roof**
- **water saving taps**
- **high insulation levels for facades, roofs and ground floor**
- **wind pressure controlled natural ventilation air supply**
- **solar collectors for preheating domestic hot water**
- **low temperature heating and individual condensing gas boilers**
- **low flush toilets**
- **sun rooms for some units**





## Adding Green to Birchmere Park

If you get a chance to visit Birchmere Park especially during the summer months, you will be pleasantly surprised by it's recent facelift. Gallions Housing Association and Thamesmead Landscape added a little extra colour to the Park by repainting the lamp posts and railings throughout the Park.





# Work begins installing new play facilities at Manorway Green, Thamesmead





Pictured above from left to right are John Fahy, Rita Edney, John Austen MP, Huw Crompton, Ambrose Gilling and Alister Macleod.

*Improvements proposed for Manorway Green, Thamesmead have now begun, thanks to the Estate Management Boards of Gallions Housing Association together with Groundwork, a local environmental regeneration charity.*

The facelift includes an imaginative new play area for children under 12, together with improved lighting, footpaths and seating.

The play area is being built around the former Tump 47, an old ammunition storage area in the days of the Arsenal and Thamesmead. A colourful wooden bridge will lead into the play area where there will be swings, a roundabout, a slide, climbing frame and a see-saw, finished off with bright safety surfacing.

The park is a result of considerable consultation with local residents and the local Bishop John Robinson primary school. Alistair Macleod, Groundwork's Community Projects Officer said "the play area should be superb. It combines safety with exciting play facilities for young children".

Works began at the beginning of May and will be completed by the end of September. Once finished, the facilities will be officially opened with a fun filled celebration event.

The improvements are funded by Gallions Housing Association and Groundwork's Single Regeneration Fund. To oversee the improvements and contribute towards the long term management of the park, a user group has now been set up. All local residents are welcome to join.

For further information please contact Alistair Macleod on 020 8691 8002.



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# Single minded approach to looking good








**Estate Management Boards, together with Gallions Housing Association, have agreed that it would be better if all the various contracts and one off services concerned with the management of external areas were brought together under the same approach.**

The management of Environmental and Estate Service contracts is a very important part of the well-being of Thamesmead and one which Gallions takes very seriously.

A working party made up of Board members, resident members of Estate Manage Boards and Gallions Officers, together with outside consultants, will look closely at applications from interested parties and select a Preferred Partner over the next few months.

The new contract will begin in September of this year. The aim is to improve environmental and estate service standards throughout Thamesmead. To make your town an even better place to live in, and an area of which we can all be proud.

Your tenant represenatives on the Estate Management Boards have worked closely with consultants to ensure the highest quality of standards are met and will be carried out in the future.

John Fahy, Chair, says "It is time to put firmly into practice the vision we all share and the experience gained over the years. Together we can make an important contribution to improving the environment of Thamesead in the future."

## The Faces of Angels



Recently, the Greenwich Good Neighbour Awards were presented to local people who have gone the extra mile to help their neighbours. Local MPs presented the prizes to over 30 winners. Shown right are some of our own good neighbours. Not only the winners from Greenwich but closer to home. Thamesmead residents took pride of place at the ceremony in April.

Gallions Housing Association was delighted to help sponsor this initiative by the London Borough of Greenwich.



**Greenwich Good Neighbour Award 2001**
**Award winners:** Robert Townsend, Carol and Eddie Hearn, Rita Edney, Peter Sinclair. **Nominations:** Mr and Mrs Awofisayo, Lena and John Rozario-Martin, Debbie Whitten, Donald Tidey.

# Results of the Board meeting of 14th June 2001

**The Gallions Housing Association Board met on the 14th June and wishes to publicise the following decisions:**

It was agreed:

a To approve the principle of the project to develop a further 32 affordable homes for rent in the Urban Village – Phase 5.

b To note the start date of 13 August for on-site work on the Ecopark project which will include 39 new affordable homes.

c To pursue partnership with the National Urban Forestry Unit to seek funding for innovative ideas for tree planting, woodland management and recycling of waste. This would involve the local community and provide training and local employment.

d That a communications strategy and manual for all staff should be implemented. This is designed to help staff improve their communications skills and to improve standards of service to customers.

PayPoint

**A new pay point is now available for customers who want to use a swipe card to pay their rent etc. The new pay point is at the Londis store, which is situated directly across from the Gallions offices.**

**Manorway Stores, 100A Harrow Manor Way London SE2 9SA. Tel: 0208 311 4427**

## Date for Your Diary

*Gallions Housing Association's First Annual General Meeting*

**Gallions Housing Association is pleased to announce the date of its First Annual General Meeting.**

**The Meeting will be on Thursday 20th September at 6pm in St Paul's Church, Bentham Rd, Thamesmead.**

**Please join us at this open meeting. Further details can be obtained from Caroline Wilson on 020 8320 3409 or Averyl Richards on 020 8320 3410.**

## FEEDBACK

What do you think of "Gallions Grapevine"? Have you any comments on our service – good or bad? What is your view of living in Thamesmead?

Let us know by writing to **FEEDBACK, Gallions Grapevine, c/o Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH.**

## Board Meetings

Gallions Housing Association's Board of Management meets on a regular basis. The meetings are open to all residents. In order to accommodate any residents who wish to attend, you would need to contact Caroline Wilson at our offices, (address below) prior to any meeting to make arrangements.

The dates of the next meetings are:

**18th October 2001**
**13th December 2001**
**14th February 2002**

All meetings are held at Gallions Housing Association offices, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH at 6.30pm.

ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾਂ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖ਼ਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਕੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਕੇ ਇਹ ਫ਼ਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾。請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

**PUNJABI** ☐ **CHINESE** ☐ **VIETNAMESE** ☐ *(please tick one)*

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

*Return to: Caroline Wilson (Translation Requests), Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH*

## Contacts

**Gallions Housing Association**
**Harrow Manor Way**
**London SE2 9XH**

**Main Switchboard**
*(for housing and other enquiries)*
**020 8310 1500**

**Repairs Freephone**
**0800 838481**

**Comfort 2000 Heating**
**020 8320 3422**

**Interserve**
**0800 389 0154**